



All those who touched my life

A debut solo by Alamu Kumaresan

Presented by Dr Bhau Daji Lad Museum

In association with Anupa Mehta Contemporary Art

Preview: Friday, 26 July 2024, 6-8 pm

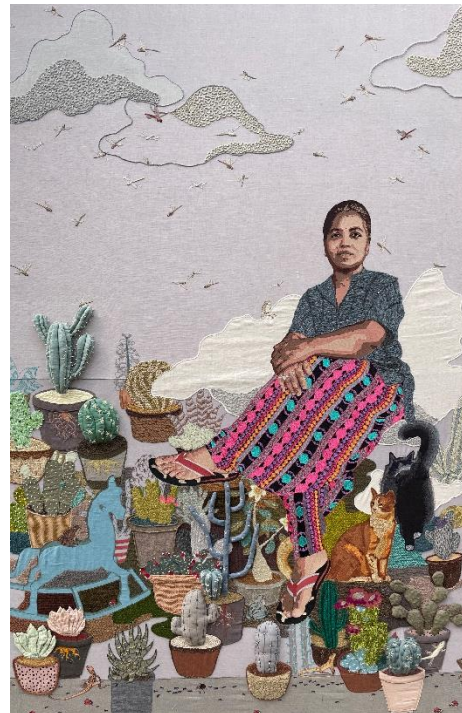
Artist Walkthrough with Tasneem Zakaria Mehta: 6.30 pm

On view from 27 July to 2 Sept 2024 | 10 am – 5:30 pm

Special Project Space, Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum, Mumbai



Raji: A portrait of strength; Yarn, thread, fabric, and oil paint on plywood, 2021-2024



Portrait of Anamika; Yarn, thread, fabric, beads, and sponge on fabric base on plywood, 2022-2024

The Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Mumbai City Museum, in association with Anupa Mehta Contemporary Art, presents, '*All those who touched my life*' a debut solo by Alamu Kumaresan. The exhibition will be on view at the Special Project Space, Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum from July 28 to Sept 2, 2024.

This exhibition brings together figurative works and self-portraits that draw upon deeply felt personal narratives that inform the artist's practice. Alamu's art can be read as a tribute to those who have touched her life. She transforms the quotidian into the remarkable in her works. The everyday is presented as heroic and made special by the artist's rich appliques and tapestries crafted out of a variety of materials. There is a timelessness in her narratives, elevating the work to a universal register in its honouring of ordinary persons.

Her use of materials such as thread, fabric, felt, and different stitching patterns stems from her family heritage: the artist hails from Karaikudi in South India. Inspired by the intricate handwork of her grandmother and mother, who were skilled in crochet, beadwork, and various embroidery techniques, she incorporates these influences into her current works. Her repertoire includes wet felt, needle felt, crochet, manual stitching, machine stitching, *Aari* embroidery, fabric crafts, punch needle craft, tie and dye, batik, and fabric sculpture. The artist's use of fabric, thread, yarn, beads, stones and embroidery, also affords her a free-flowing vocabulary and a therapeutic experience.

Apart from the figurative works, Alamu also creates abstract tapestries and landscapes informed by the vagaries of nature. She writes, "Whether it's plants, insects, or mountains, each element impacts my creative process. My work mirrors this diversity, capturing nature's essence. I find fulfilment in translating nature's textures into intricate patterns."

Tasneem Zakaria Mehta, Managing Trustee & Director, Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum, states, "Alamu Kumaresan's work immediately struck me for its originality and vitality. Her creative use of various stitching and embroidery techniques recalls not only her own maternal patrimony but also a rich tradition of reclaiming creative feminine practices that were earlier relegated to the margins."

Anupa Mehta, Director, AMCA adds, "We are privileged to show Alamu's unique vocabulary at such a prestigious venue. That the artist's work was selected by Tasneem Zakaria Mehta, is indicative of the maturity of the practice."

About Alamu Kumaresan

Born in 1983, Alamu Kumaresan earned a Master in Fine Arts in painting from Madras University, Government College of Fine Arts in 2007. She has participated in the Korea Golden Jubilee of Inko, the International exchange exhibition at Busan, Korea, 2023; 'Confluence' Chennai Biennale 2024 organized by INKO Centre at Lalit Kala Akademi, 2024. Having been an art facilitator has provided her with an intensive work experience with young minds. Alamu Kumaresan's works are in the form of intricate patterns and textures woven with fabric, thread, Yarn, embroidery and paint. Her unique vocabulary is inspired by people around her. She says, "The diversity and uniqueness of people we encounter on a daily basis offer endless opportunities to listen, learn, and be inspired. I'm captivated by those who approach life with bravery, respect for all life forms, gratitude and inclusivity. Their infectious perspective, grit and resilience inspire me deeply."

About Anupa Mehta Contemporary Art

ANUPA MEHTA CONTEMPORARY ART (AMCA), now located in Colaba on the Mumbai Art Mile, was initiated in 2008 as THE LOFT at Lower Parel, and was earlier housed in an erstwhile mill in the heart of Mumbai's textile district. The new gallery space opened in December 2023, but their program in support of mid-career contemporary artists with exceptional vocabularies has been ongoing since the past 16 years. The gallery is spearheaded by Anupa Mehta, founding editor *Art India* magazine and is the author of INDIA 20, a prescient book of interviews with leading contemporary artists.

About Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum

The Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum is Mumbai's first museum, established in 1857, and is the erstwhile Victoria and Albert Museum, Bombay.

The Museum building and collections underwent a comprehensive, UNESCO-Award winning restoration, spearheaded by the Mumbai Chapter of the Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage (INTACH), and supported by the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai and the Jamnalal Bajaj Foundation. Since it opened to the public in 2008, the Museum has pioneered contemporary art which is presented in the extraordinary 19th-century building, one of the finest in India, in an attempt to rethink the cannon and challenge colonial and enlightenment precepts.

The Museum was built to showcase the city's contemporary art and craftsmanship through a rare collection of fine and decorative arts of India. The Museum's robust exhibition and outreach programme invites artists to engage with these collections and archives and interrogate its founding principles.

Over 85 exhibitions have been presented, which include collaborations with both local and international institutions and organisations. Past exhibitions have showcased contemporary creative practices in design, crafts and textiles, architecture, urbanism, and film and video art. To mark its 150th anniversary in 2022, the Museum brought out a book titled '*Mumbai: A City Through Objects, 101 Stories from the Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum*', edited by the Director, Tasneem Zakaria Mehta. The book was co-published with Harper Design, Harper Collins' new design imprint, and has won several awards.

The exhibition is on view at:

Special Project Space, Museum Plaza,

Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum, Veermata Jijabai Bhosale Botanical Udyan and Zoo (Rani Bagh), 91-A, Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Road, Byculla (E), Mumbai – 400027

Timings: 10 am to 5:30 pm | Closed all Wednesdays and certain public holidays

Free entry

For more information about the Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Mumbai City Museum, please visit www.bdlmuseum.org

Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/bdlmuseum/>

Facebook: www.facebook.com/BDLMuseum

Twitter: <https://twitter.com/BDLMuseum>

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Kindly note that the main Museum building is currently closed due to essential repairs.